



Accessibility Audit Report

Sandusky County Clerk of Courts Website

sandusky-county.org/clerk/ | WCAG 2.1 Level AA | ADA Title II

10 Files Audited

121 Total Fixes

Materialize CSS Framework

June 2026

OVERVIEW

This report documents WCAG 2.1 Level AA / ADA Title II accessibility findings for the Sandusky County Clerk of Courts PHP website. Ten PHP template files were audited. All corrections are accessibility-only — no visual design or layout changes were made.

10

FILES AUDITED

121

TOTAL FIXES

26

UNIQUE ISSUES

AA

WCAG TARGET

SCOPE & STANDARDS

Standard: WCAG 2.1 Level AA | **Law:** ADA Title II (state/local government) |

Framework: Materialize CSS

Files covered in this audit:

- `nav.php` — Site navigation (included on all pages)
- `index.php` — Homepage with card grid
- `pay.php` — Pay Online
- `docket.php` — Online Docket
- `titles.php` — Title Office forms (12 PDF downloads)
- `cp_fees.php` — Common Pleas Filing Fees (fee tables)
- `cp_forms.php` — Common Pleas Online Forms (static + database-driven)
- `contact_clerk.php` — Clerk of Courts contact
- `contact_county.php` — County Courts contact (Clyde & Woodville)
- `contact_title.php` — Title Office contact

Note: `nav.php` is included on every page. All `nav.php` fixes propagate site-wide automatically once that single file is updated.

FILES AT A GLANCE

`nav.php`

27 fixes

`index.php`

13 fixes

`pay.php`

14 fixes

`docket.php`

8 fixes

titles.php

13 fixes

cp_fees.php

9 fixes

cp_forms.php

9 fixes

contact_clerk.php

9 fixes

contact_county.php

11 fixes

contact_title.php

8 fixes

RECURRING ISSUES (SITE-WIDE PATTERNS)

The following issues appear on every page and were fixed consistently throughout the audit.

Pattern	WCAG	Fix Applied	Pages Affected
Non-unique <title> All pages used "Sandusky County Clerk of Courts"	2.4.2	Each page given a unique title: <i>Page Name Sandusky County Clerk of Courts</i>	All 9 content pages
Empty

 spacers in parallax	1.3.1	Removed — spacing achieved by existing CSS	All 9 content pages
Parallax Background image has descriptive alt text	1.1.1	alt="" — marks as decorative	All 9 content pages
Missing id="main-content" Skip link in nav.php has no target	2.4.1	Added id="main-content" to .light-tan wrapper	All 9 content pages

Pattern	WCAG	Fix Applied	Pages Affected
Orange <h1> text on parallax background class="orange-text" — contrast may fail against photo	1.4.3	Flagged for client — manual contrast test against photo required	All 9 content pages
External / PDF links missing rel="noopener"	2.4.4	Added rel="noopener" to all target="_blank" links	Multiple pages
PDF links with no format/new-tab disclosure	2.4.4	Added aria-label="... (PDF, opens in new tab)"	titles.php, cp_forms.php, cp_fees (nav)
Contact blocks not in <address> Phone/address/hours in plain <p> elements	1.3.1	Wrapped in <address style="font-style:normal;">	titles.php, contact_clerk.php, contact_county.php, contact_title.php
Phone links missing aria-label	2.4.6	Added aria-label="Phone: ..."	titles.php, contact_clerk.php, contact_county.php, contact_title.php
Material Icons read aloud by screen readers <i class="material-icons"> ligature text announced	1.3.1	Added aria-hidden="true" to all icon elements	nav.php, contact_county.php

DETAILED FINDINGS — NAV.PHP

nav.php — Site Navigation

27 fixes

Included on every page. All fixes here propagate site-wide automatically.

#	Issue	WCAG	Severity	Fix
1	No skip link on any page	2.4.1	Critical	Added Skip to main content with CSS show-on-focus
2	role="navigation" on <nav> — redundant	1.3.1	Medium	Removed; added aria-label to differentiate multiple navs
3	Top nav missing aria-label	1.3.1	Medium	aria-label="Site header"

#	Issue	WCAG	Severity	Fix
4	Main nav missing aria-label	1.3.1	Medium	aria-label="Main navigation"
5	Sidenav trigger href="#" — page jump on click	2.1.1	High	Changed to href="#!"
6	Sidenav trigger missing accessible label — icon only	1.1.1	Critical	Added aria-label="Open navigation menu"
7–12	6 × dropdown trigger links missing aria-haspopup / aria-expanded	4.1.2	High	Added aria-haspopup="true" aria-expanded="false" to all
13–18	6 × dropdown trigger href="#" — page jump	2.1.1	High	Changed all to href="#!"
19–24	6 × <i class="material-icons"> read aloud	1.3.1	Medium	Added aria-hidden="true"
25–26	Orphaned dropdown-titles and dropdown-titles2 menus — placeholder href="#!" links only	2.4.4	Medium	Removed both menus
27	Skip link CSS missing from stylesheet	2.4.1	Critical	Added inline <style> with show-on-focus pattern

Client flags:

- dropdown-clyde2 links to FilingFees2013.pdf while dropdown-clyde links to 25_court_costs.pdf — verify which is current.
- http://codes.ohio.gov/ uses HTTP — update to HTTPS if available.

DETAILED FINDINGS — INDEX.PHP

index.php — Homepage

13 fixes

#	Issue	WCAG	Severity	Fix
1	Non-unique <title>	2.4.2	High	Sandusky County Clerk of Courts Sandusky County Clerk of Courts → homepage uses site name as page name; acceptable for index

#	Issue	WCAG	Severity	Fix
2	 spacers in parallax	1.3.1	Medium	Removed
3	Parallax alt="Peaceful Tree Scene"	1.1.1	Medium	alt=""
4	Missing id="main-content"	2.4.1	High	Added to .light-tan wrapper
5	No visible <h1> in main content area	1.3.1	High	Added <h1 class="sr-only">Sandusky County Clerk of Courts</h1>
6–9	4 × card — double announcement	1.1.1	High	alt="" on all card images
10–13	4 × card headings <h4> — skips h2, h3	1.3.1	High	Changed to <h2>; CSS fix: #card-sect h2 { font-size:1.64rem; line-height:1.3; margin:0; }

CSS required in stylesheet:

```
#card-sect h2 { font-size: 1.64rem; line-height: 1.3; margin: 0; }
.sr-only { position:absolute; width:1px; height:1px; padding:0; margin:-1px; overflow:hidden; clip:rect(0,0,0,0); white-space:nowrap; border:0; }
```

The margin: 0 is critical — Materialize's default h2 margins are larger than h4, which breaks the parallax hero card overlap without this reset.

DETAILED FINDINGS — PAY.PHP

pay.php — Pay Online

14 fixes

#	Issue	WCAG	Severity	Fix
1	Non-unique <title>	2.4.2	High	Pay Online Sandusky County Clerk of Courts
2	 spacers in parallax	1.3.1	Medium	Removed

#	Issue	WCAG	Severity	Fix
3	Parallax alt="Peaceful Tree Scene"	1.1.1	Medium	alt=""
4	Missing id="main-content"	2.4.1	High	Added to .light-tan wrapper
5–8	4 × card 	1.1.1	High	alt="" on all
9–12	4 × card headings <h4>	1.3.1	High	Changed to <h2>
13	 inside heading: "Clyde Court County Court #1"	1.3.1	Medium	Replaced with em dash: <i>Clyde Court — County Court #1</i>
14	4 × external payment links missing rel="noopener" + new-tab disclosure	2.4.4	High	Added rel="noopener" + descriptive aria-label

DETAILED FINDINGS — DOCKET.PHP

docket.php — Online Docket

8 fixes

#	Issue	WCAG	Severity	Fix
1	Non-unique <title>	2.4.2	High	<i>Online Docket Sandusky County Clerk of Courts</i>
2	 spacers in parallax	1.3.1	Medium	Removed
3	Parallax alt="Peaceful Tree Scene"	1.1.1	Medium	alt=""
4	Missing id="main-content"	2.4.1	High	Added to .light-tan wrapper
5–6	Notice headings using non-semantic bold/caps text	1.3.1	High	Changed to <h2 class="dark-sage-text">NOTICE</h2> and <h2>NOTICE TO PROSPECTIVE EMPLOYERS</h2>
7–8	External docket links missing rel="noopener" + new-tab disclosure	2.4.4	High	Added rel="noopener" + aria-label

titles.php — Title Office Forms

13 fixes

#	Issue	WCAG	Severity	Fix
1	Non-unique <title>	2.4.2	High	<i>Titles Sandusky County Clerk of Courts</i>
2	 spacers in parallax	1.3.1	Medium	Removed
3	Parallax alt="Peaceful Tree Scene"	1.1.1	Medium	alt=""
4	Missing id="main-content"	2.4.1	High	Added to .light-tan wrapper
5–16 (×12)	12 × card — duplicates adjacent heading	1.1.1	High	alt="" on all 12
17–28 (×12)	12 × card headings <h4> — skips levels	1.3.1	High	Changed all to <h2>
29–40 (×12)	12 × PDF links missing rel="noopener" + format disclosure	2.4.4	High	Added rel="noopener" + aria-label="...(PDF, opens in new tab)"
5*	Phone (419) 334-9407 plain text — not a link	2.4.4	Medium	
6*	Google Maps link missing rel="noopener" + new-tab disclosure	2.4.4	High	Added both
7*	Address/contact block not in <address>	1.3.1	Medium	Wrapped in <address style="font-style:normal;">

* Items 5*–7* are separate from the 12-card pattern items above; row numbers simplified for readability.

CSS required in stylesheet (same as index.php):

```
#card-sect h2 { font-size: 1.64rem; line-height: 1.3; margin: 0; }
```


DETAILED FINDINGS — CP_FEES.PHP

cp_fees.php — Common Pleas Filing Fees

9 fixes

#	Issue	WCAG	Severity	Fix
1	Non-unique <title>	2.4.2	High	Common Pleas Filing Fees Sandusky County Clerk of Courts
2	 spacers in parallax	1.3.1	Medium	Removed
3	Parallax alt="Peaceful Tree Scene"	1.1.1	Medium	alt=""
4	Missing id="main-content"	2.4.1	High	Added to .light-tan wrapper
5–7	3 × <th colspan="2"> table section headers missing scope="colgroup"	1.3.1	High	Added scope="colgroup"
8–10	3 × tables have no column headers — screen reader cannot identify columns	1.3.1	High	Added <th scope="col" class="sr-only">Description</th> and <th scope="col" class="sr-only">Amount</th> to each
11	Footnote asterisk mismatch: * in table row, ** in <p> outside	1.3.1	Medium	Normalized to *; added id="fee-note" + role="note"; linked table via aria-describedby="fee-note"

DETAILED FINDINGS — CP_FORMS.PHP

cp_forms.php — Common Pleas Online Forms

9 fixes

#	Issue	WCAG	Severity	Fix
1	Non-unique <title>	2.4.2	High	Common Pleas Online Forms Sandusky County Clerk of Courts
2	 spacers in parallax	1.3.1	Medium	Removed
3	Parallax alt="Peaceful Tree Scene"	1.1.1	Medium	alt=""

#	Issue	WCAG	Severity	Fix
4	Missing <code>id="main-content"</code>	2.4.1	High	Added to <code>.light-tan</code> wrapper
5	14 × static PDF links missing <code>rel="noopener"</code> + <code>format/new-tab</code> disclosure	2.4.4	High	Added <code>rel="noopener"</code> + <code>aria-label="...(PDF, opens in new tab)"</code>
6	Dynamic card links (PHP loop) missing <code>rel="noopener"</code> + disclosure	2.4.4	High	Added to <code><a></code> template with dynamic <code>aria-label</code> from <code>\$forms[\$x]["Name"]</code>
7	<code><h2 class="orange-text">Supreme Court of Ohio Forms</h2></code> — orange contrast	1.4.3	High	Flagged for client — manual contrast test required
8–9	PHP output <code><?= \$forms[\$x] ["PDF"]; ?></code> etc. — unescaped database values (XSS)	—	Security	Wrapped all three output variables in <code>htmlspecialchars()</code>

Security note: The `htmlspecialchars()` additions on `Name`, `Desc`, and `PDF` outputs are not a WCAG item but prevent reflected XSS if database content is ever manipulated. Recommend flagging to your developer.

DETAILED FINDINGS — CONTACT_CLERK.PHP

contact_clerk.php — Clerk of Courts Contact

9 fixes

#	Issue	WCAG	Severity	Fix
1	Non-unique <code><title></code>	2.4.2	High	<i>Contact the Clerk Sandusky County Clerk of Courts</i>
2	<code>

</code> spacers in parallax	1.3.1	Medium	Removed
3	Parallax <code>alt="Peaceful Tree Scene"</code>	1.1.1	Medium	<code>alt=""</code>
4	Missing <code>id="main-content"</code>	2.4.1	High	Added to <code>.light-tan</code> wrapper
5	Contact info in plain <code><p></code> elements — not in <code><address></code>	1.3.1	Medium	Wrapped in <code><address style="font-style:normal;"></code>

#	Issue	WCAG	Severity	Fix
6	Phone link href="tel:+1-419-334-6161" missing aria-label	2.4.6	Medium	aria-label="Phone: 419-334-6161"
7	Email uses old co.sandusky.oh.us domain	—	Flag	Flagged for client — confirm if @sanduskycountyoh.gov is correct
8	Google Maps link missing rel="noopener" + new-tab disclosure	2.4.4	High	Added both
9	Orange h1 contrast	1.4.3	High	Flagged for client

DETAILED FINDINGS — CONTACT_COUNTY.PHP

contact_county.php — County Courts Contact

11 fixes

#	Issue	WCAG	Severity	Fix
1	Non-unique <title>	2.4.2	High	County Courts Contact Information Sandusky County Clerk of Courts
2	 spacers in parallax	1.3.1	Medium	Removed
3	Parallax alt="Peaceful Tree Scene"	1.1.1	Medium	alt=""
4	Missing id="main-content"	2.4.1	High	Added to .light-tan wrapper
5–6	2 × <div class="card-header"> — non-semantic, not announced as heading	1.3.1	High	Changed to <h3 class="card-header"> (h1 → h2 → h3 hierarchy)
7	12 × <i class="material-icons"> icon ligatures read aloud	1.3.1	Medium	Added aria-hidden="true" to all
8	Fax <p> × 2 — icon hidden but no "Fax:" text label	1.3.1	Medium	Added Fax: prefix text to both
9–10	4 × phone links missing aria-label (2 main + 2 probation)	2.4.6	Medium	Added aria-label="Phone: ..." and aria-label="Probation phone: ..."

#	Issue	WCAG	Severity	Fix
11	2 × address blocks not in <address>	1.3.1	Medium	Wrapped each card's contact info in <address style="font-style:normal;">
12–13	2 × Google Maps links missing rel="noopener" + new-tab disclosure	2.4.4	High	Added both

CSS note: `h3.card-header { margin: 0; }` may be needed if Materialize's default h3 margins add unwanted space to the card header. No visual change otherwise — the `.card-header` class retains all styling.

DETAILED FINDINGS — CONTACT_TITLE.PHP

contact_title.php — Title Office Contact

8 fixes

#	Issue	WCAG	Severity	Fix
1	Non-unique <title>	2.4.2	High	<i>Title Office Contact Information Sandusky County Clerk of Courts</i>
2	 spacers in parallax	1.3.1	Medium	Removed
3	Parallax alt="Peaceful Tree Scene"	1.1.1	Medium	alt=""
4	Missing id="main-content"	2.4.1	High	Added to .light-tan wrapper
5	Contact info in plain <p> elements — not in <address>	1.3.1	Medium	Wrapped in <address style="font-style:normal;">
6	Phone link missing aria-label	2.4.6	Medium	aria-label="Phone: 419-334-9407"
7	Google Maps link missing rel="noopener" + new-tab disclosure	2.4.4	High	Added both
8	Orange h1 contrast	1.4.3	High	Flagged for client

CLIENT ACTION ITEMS

The following items require a decision or verification by the client before they can be resolved.

File	Item	Action Required
All pages	Orange <code><h1></code> text over parallax photo background	Test contrast ratio with a tool like WebAIM Contrast Checker against the actual photo. If ratio fails 4.5:1, switch to white or a darker accessible color.
nav.php	dropdown-clyde2 links to FilingFees2013.pdf (2013) while dropdown-clyde links to 25_court_costs.pdf	Verify which filing fee document is current and remove or update the outdated link.
nav.php	<code>http://codes.ohio.gov/</code> — uses HTTP	Confirm whether <code>https://codes.ohio.gov/</code> is available and update accordingly.
contact_clerk.php	Email <code>clerk@co.sandusky.oh.us</code> — old domain	Confirm if mailbox has migrated to <code>@sanduskycountyoh.gov</code> . Update both href and display text if so.
cp_forms.php	<code><h2 class="orange-text">Supreme Court of Ohio Forms</h2></code>	Test orange text on tan background for 4.5:1 contrast. Update color if failing.
cp_forms.php	Database output not escaped — XSS risk (security, not WCAG)	Developer to confirm <code>htmlspecialchars()</code> additions are compatible with existing data and that no double-encoding occurs.

REQUIRED CSS ADDITIONS (STYLESHEET)

The following rules must be added to the site's main stylesheet. They have no visual effect except where noted.

Rule	Purpose	Visual Effect
<pre>.skip-link { position:absolute; top:-50px; left:0; background:#2e5e4e; color:#fff; padding:10px 18px; font- size:14px; font-weight:bold; text- decoration:none; z-index:99999; border- radius:0 0 4px 0; } .skip-link:focus { top:0; }</pre>	Shows skip-to-content link on keyboard focus (WCAG 2.4.1)	Invisible until Tab key — then appears top-left
<pre>.sr-only { position:absolute; width:1px; height:1px; padding:0; margin:-1px; overflow:hidden; clip:rect(0,0,0,0); white-space:nowrap; border:0; }</pre>	Visually hides elements while keeping them in the accessibility tree	None — invisible to sighted users
<pre>#card-sect h2 { font-size: 1.64rem; line-height: 1.3; margin: 0; }</pre>	Resets Materialize h2 defaults so card heading size matches original h4 and parallax hero overlap is preserved	Cards look identical to original design
<pre>h3.card-header { margin: 0; }</pre>	Resets Materialize h3 margins on card headers in contact_county.php	Card header height unchanged